

Data-Protection Compliance Report

O&M Cane Training app — research pilot

From: Aditya Shetty · **To:** Mansi (pilot manager, IIT Delhi) · **Date:** 3 July 2026

1. Executive summary

The app now fully implements the consent and data-deletion requirements of India's Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 (DPDP Act) and the DPDP Rules, 2025 for the most sensitive thing we do — recording video of children. Consent is taken on paper from a parent or legal guardian at the school, mirrored inside the app as a verifiable record, and enforced by the software itself: the app is technically incapable of storing a video for a child whose guardian has not consented. Alongside the app changes, five compliance documents have been prepared (privacy policy, guardian consent form in English and Hindi, Play Store data-safety answers, and a compliance map for the legal team). This report explains what was built, why, and the small set of actions needed from you, the legal team, and the content team.

2. Why this was necessary

Every child in our pilot is under 18, so the DPDP Act treats all of their data as children's data — the most protected category in the law, with the highest penalty ceiling (up to Rs. 200 crore for failures involving children's data). Rule 10 of the DPDP Rules, 2025 (notified 13 November 2025) requires **verifiable** parental consent before processing: it is not enough that someone agreed — we must be able to show who agreed, that they are the child's parent or legal guardian, and how their identity was checked. Teacher-filmed video of a child is our highest-sensitivity data, so it received its own separate consent, independent of the general assessment consent.

3. The consent workflow, end to end

Step 1 — On paper, at the school.

The guardian receives one consent form with two parts. Part A covers participation in the assessments. Part B — optional and separately signed — covers video recording. A guardian can refuse video and the child still participates fully; the form says this explicitly. When the form is signed, a school staff member sights the guardian's ID and notes which document was seen. The signed paper stays at the school, filed as the legal evidence of consent.

Step 2 — Mirrored in the app at enrolment.

When the teacher enrolls the child, ticking "guardian consent for video" opens three required fields: the guardian's name, their relation to the child (mother / father / legal guardian), and how consent was taken (signed paper form, verbal in person, other). The app refuses to save a bare tick — a consent without a name and relation is not verifiable, so it cannot be recorded. The date is stamped automatically.

Step 3 — Enforced at every session.

If consent is on file, the teacher can attach a video to a session; the clip is stored under the child's anonymous research code (e.g. OM-7KQ2-M4XP), never their name. If consent is absent, the video control appears locked and inert. Crucially, this is not only a visual lock: the internal function that writes video to storage independently re-checks consent and refuses without it. Even a software bug in the interface could not cause an unconsented video to be stored — the gate sits on the disk-write itself, and it fails closed.

Step 4 — Withdrawal, any time.

If a guardian changes their mind, they tell the school and the teacher unticks the consent box. Video locks again immediately. The app records the withdrawal date but preserves the original consent record — the audit trail proving consent existed for past recordings is never erased. If clips are already stored, the app

asks the teacher whether those should be deleted too (the guardian's right to erasure), and does so on confirmation.

Step 5 — Deletion that actually deletes.

Deleting a single result, deleting a child, or wiping the device now removes the video **files** from storage, not merely the database entries pointing at them. No orphaned children's data can remain on a device after a deletion.

Step 6 — Auditable exports.

Every data export carries a consent column per row — Yes, No, or Withdrawn, with dates — so the research team can prove at any moment that no video exists without consent behind it. The guardian's own name (which is also personal data) appears only in the separate, explicitly-requested identification sheet, under the same rule that protects child names and dates of birth.

4. Documents prepared (in the project's compliance folder)

GUARDIAN-CONSENT-FORM.pdf	The printable paper form described above — Part A assessment, Part B video, plus the school's ID-verification block.
GUARDIAN-CONSENT-FORM-HINDI.md	Hindi translation of the form, awaiting verification by the content team before printing.
PRIVACY-POLICY.md	DPDP-compliant privacy policy, ready to publish once the legal team confirms the entity of record and grievance officer.
PLAY-DATA-SAFETY.md	Prepared answers for Google Play's mandatory Data Safety questionnaire.
DPDP-COMPLIANCE-MAP.md	A requirement-by-requirement map from the law to the exact control in the app — the legal team's review checklist.

5. A useful finding for the Play Store release

Google applies its strict "Families" review to apps whose **users** include children. Our users are teachers; children never operate the app. Declaring the target audience as 18+ therefore keeps us out of the Families review entirely, while the children's data the app handles is still fully and honestly disclosed in the Data Safety form. This removes a review-risk we had previously budgeted for.

6. What we need, from whom

From you (Mansi):

- Arrange consent-form signing at the three schools (an enrolment day or parent meeting per school) **before any filming starts**. Blank forms just need printing.
- Route the compliance map to whoever acts as our legal reviewer.
- The real teacher names for each school (already pending) — needed before logins are issued.

From the legal team (all flagged inside the compliance map):

- Confirm the legal entity of record (data fiduciary) and name a grievance-officer contact.
- Confirm that school-sighted ID at form signing satisfies Rule 10's identity due-diligence for an offline pilot.
- Advise whether the educational-institution exemption in the Rules applies to us (the app takes consent regardless, so this affects paperwork only).

From the content team:

- Verify and typeset the Hindi consent form before printing for Jaipur, Kullu and Noida parents.

7. Current status and next steps

All app-side compliance work described above is implemented, verified, and committed to the project repository. The remaining engineering items on the production roadmap (cloud sync with an India-region database, school-level access isolation, and the Play Store release) each have their compliance requirements already designed in — for example, the cloud uploader will re-check consent before any clip leaves a device, and deletion requests will propagate to the server. I will share a short costing note separately for the cloud component (approximately US\$25/month during data collection).

Prepared by Aditya Shetty · O&M Cane Training pilot · Questions welcome — happy to walk through any section or the app itself.